ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 1: **Natural Resources and Their Use** | Class 8 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** The totality of life and non-life forms not created by humans	Nature includes living and non-living parts of the environment
2	**(c)** benefits that humans get from ecosystem functions	e.g. clean water, pollination
3	**(b)** 2016	All farmland certified organic
4	**(b)** breeding season	Allowed fish to breed
5	**(b)** used by humans to meet needs	Use gives value to a thing
6	**(a)** service	Benefit to humans
7	**(a)** using compost, neem and multiple crops	Natural farming methods
8	**(b)** 50 more years	A reason to look for alternatives
9	**(d)** It must be very old	The three conditions are technology, economy and culture
10	**(a)** unevenly across the Earth	Hence trade and sometimes conflict

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Totality of life and non-life forms in the environment (1); Not created by humans (1).	1+1
12	Functions are the inherent ways Nature works (1); Services are the benefits humans get from them (1).	1+1
13	Water-intensive crops like paddy and wheat (1); Free power for pumping (1).	1+1
14	Technologically accessible and economically feasible (1); Culturally acceptable (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	For life: air or water (1); For materials: wood or marble (1); For energy: coal or sunlight (1).	1+1+1
16	Reserves may last about 50 years (1); It is non-renewable (1); Alternatives such as solar and wind are needed (1).	1+1+1
17	Stopped chemical inputs (1); Used compost, neem and garlic repellents and mixed crops (1); Sold premium organic produce (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Oil deep under the sea needs technology to reach it (1); It must be affordable to extract (1); Society must accept the extraction (1).	1+1+1
18	Industries and jobs near resources (1); Trade between regions and countries (1); Disputes, e.g. Kaveri (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Biodiversity improved (1); Tourism increased (1); Farmers earned higher incomes (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Technological accessibility with an example (2); Economic feasibility with an example (1); Cultural acceptability with an example (1); Why the conditions change over time (1).	2+1+1+1
	OR: Crop pattern causes (1); Free power and over-pumping (1); Falling water table, chemicals (1); Rain-water harvesting and ponds (1); Diversified cropping (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Resources for life: air, water (renewable) (2); Resources for materials: wood (renewable), minerals (non-renewable) (1); Resources for energy: sunlight (renewable), coal (non-renewable) (1); Overlap of categories (1).	2+1+1+1
	OR: Meaning and author (1); Contents on soil and seeds (1); Mixed cropping and pest control (1); Relevance to organic farming (1); Link with traditional knowledge (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Nature means only forests and rivers; it includes all living and non-living things not created by humans.
- Calling every resource renewable: timber and fish are renewable only if use stays below the rate of regeneration; coal and petroleum are non-renewable.
- Forgetting the **three** tests for a resource: technology, economic feasibility and cultural acceptability (age or distance is not a test).

- Mixing up **restoration** (back to the original state) with **regeneration** (new life and conditions), and ecosystem *function* with ecosystem *service*.
- Quoting figures wrongly: a mature tree gives about 275 litres of oxygen a day while a human needs about 350 litres; Sikkim went organic in 2016; the International Solar Alliance was launched with France in 2015.
- Treating the resource curse as 'resources cause poverty'; it means that plenty alone does not ensure development without value addition.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 1: **Natural Resources and Their Use** | Class 8 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** care of plants and trees	'Vriksha' means tree
2	**(c)** store water that feeds rivers	Rivers like Ganga and Indus draw on them
3	**(a)** air, water and food	Life cannot exist without them
4	**(b)** Puducherry	Four riparian states or UTs
5	**(a)** France	Launched in 2015
6	**(d)** adding value through industries	India invested in processing
7	**(a)** materials	They are converted into objects
8	**(d)** slow growth in some resource-rich regions	Resource wealth does not always bring development
9	**(c)** Rajasthan	A large solar park in the desert state
10	**(d)** using it faster than Nature can renew it	Leads to depletion

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Resources are unevenly distributed (1); Trade helps meet needs that local supply cannot (1).	1+1
12	Fine dust damages lungs (1); Dust settles on crops and pollutes soil and water (1).	1+1
13	Restoration: returning to the original healthy state (1); Regeneration: creating new life so that Nature thrives (1).	1+1
14	Resource-rich regions may grow slowly (1); They may fail to build processing industries (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	When used faster than it regenerates (1); Cutting timber faster than trees grow (1); Natural rhythm is disturbed (1).	1+1+1
16	Built industries that add value (1); Invested in knowledge and skills (1); Good planning and governance (1).	1+1+1
17	Which plants suit which soil (1); Seed care and seasonal watering (1); Natural pest control and crop rotation (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Tree decomposes with the help of fungi and bacteria (1); Insects and organisms feed on it (1); Soil is enriched for new plants (1).	1+1+1
18	High-yielding paddy and wheat need much water (1); Free power led to over-pumping (1); About 80% of area is over-exploited (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Launched the International Solar Alliance in 2015 (1); Built large solar parks like Bhadla (1); Helps developing countries with funds and skills (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Meaning of restoration (1); Meaning of regeneration (1); Over-harvesting timber (1); Over-fishing (1); Glacier melt (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: International Solar Alliance (1); Bhadla Solar Park (1); Help to other nations (1); Reduces fossil fuel use (1); Climate and economy benefits (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Resources are uneven (1); Trade links places (1); Displacement of people (1); Kaveri dispute (1); Need for cooperation (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Cause: over-pumping for such crops (2); Remedy: rain-water harvesting and pond revival (1); Remedy: crop diversification (1); Link to Punjab (1).	2+1+1+1

Mistakes to avoid:

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- Calling every resource renewable: timber and fish are renewable only if use stays below the rate of regeneration; coal and petroleum are non-renewable.
- Forgetting the **three** tests for a resource: technology, economic feasibility and cultural acceptability (age or distance is not a test).
- Mixing up **restoration** (back to the original state) with **regeneration** (new life and conditions), and ecosystem *function* with ecosystem *service*.

- Quoting figures wrongly: a mature tree gives about 275 litres of oxygen a day while a human needs about 350 litres; Sikkim went organic in 2016; the International Solar Alliance was launched with France in 2015.
- Treating the resource curse as 'resources cause poverty'; it means that plenty alone does not ensure development without value addition.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 1: **Natural Resources and Their Use** | Class 8 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** energy	They power machines and homes
2	**(d)** Using resources wisely so renewables can regenerate	Care and responsibility
3	**(c)** River water	Water is replenished by rain
4	**(d)** A forest growing back after a fire with fresh life	New life and conditions thrive
5	**(a)** Nature can restore and regenerate over time	e.g. wind, river water, timber
6	**(a)** water-intensive crops and heavy pumping	Wheat and paddy need much water
7	**(b)** becomes depleted	Rate of use exceeds regeneration
8	**(a)** Resources for life	Needed for survival
9	**(d)** Petroleum	Petroleum takes millions of years to form
10	**(b)** About 80%	As given in the chapter

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Group of sunshine-rich countries launched in 2015 (1); Started by India and France to promote solar energy (1).	1+1
12	Renewable: Nature restores them, e.g. wind (1); Non-renewable: take millions of years, e.g. coal (1).	1+1
13	Respecting Nature and using resources wisely (1); Letting renewables regenerate and using non-renewables carefully (1).	1+1
14	Ancient Indian science of the care of plants (1); Surapala's text, about the 10th century CE (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	They store water for rivers like the Ganga (1); Rising temperatures melt them faster (1); Melt is faster than replacement by snow (1).	1+1+1
16	Rain-water harvesting and reviving ponds (1); Reusing water and reducing waste (1); Crop diversification and natural fertilisers (1).	1+1+1
17	A mature tree gives about 275 litres a day (1); A person needs about 350 litres (1); More trees are needed than people (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Avoided fishing in the spawning season (1); Allowed fish to breed and numbers to recover (1); Modern over-fishing breaks this balance, e.g. tuna (1).	1+1+1
18	Needed for houses, roads and bridges (1); Dust harms health and crops (1); Alternatives like stone and mud can reduce use (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Saving water and electricity (1); Reusing and recycling (1); Planting and protecting trees (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Meaning (1); Why growth stays slow (1); India builds processing industries (1); Role of skills and governance (1); Wootz steel as an example of value addition (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Meaning: welfare of all (1); Fair sharing (1); Responsible extraction (1); Care for future generations (1); Examples (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Meaning of stewardship (2); Punjab: causes of water loss (1); Cement: pollution and alternatives (1); Sikkim: organic success (1).	2+1+1+1
	OR: Decomposition cycle (1); Water cycle and glaciers (1); Disturbance causes depletion (1); Over-fishing example (1); Need to respect natural rhythm (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Mistakes to avoid:

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